Weekly cetuximab + FOLFOX-4

Supportive-care review sheet · Individualise with the team; not a prescription.

Before treatment

Confirm exact indication, current symptoms, allergies, blood counts, renal/liver function and medicines. Validated extended RAS wild type is required for colorectal cetuximab; it is not the selection test for head/neck radiotherapy. Check minerals, previous infusion reactions, red-meat allergy and tick bites. Confirm DPD testing before fluorouracil; interpret uracil phenotyping cautiously with renal impairment.

Premedication and nausea

Cetuximab antihistamine plus corticosteroid at least one hour before infusion, including subsequent infusions; follow local policy. Antiemetics per NCCP/local moderate-risk protocol. moderate emetogenic risk; provide rescue instructions.

Administration

Cetuximab on Day 1 and Day 8. Day 1: oxaliplatin and folinic acid, then fluorouracil bolus and a 22-hour infusion. Day 2: further fluorouracil bolus and a second 22-hour infusion; completion around Day 3. A repeating 14-day cycle. The number of cycles depends on benefit, side effects and your treatment plan. Chemotherapy starts no earlier than one hour after cetuximab ends. Weekly first infusion about 120 minutes, subsequent 60 minutes; fortnightly 500 mg/m² over 120 minutes. Observe per source and local policy.

Skin, nerves and minerals

Provide EGFR skin-care plan, sun protection and prescribed treatments. Track severe skin episode number, delay and recovery. Monitor electrolytes during and monthly for two months after cetuximab. Assess functional neuropathy and cold symptoms. Avoid cold exposure/ice chips; oxaliplatin requires glucose-compatible lines and flushes.

Bowel symptoms

Give the written diarrhoea, hydration and escalation plan. Fever, blood, severe pain, reduced urine or inability to drink require urgent assessment.

Access and discharge

Confirm port/PICC care, pump/spill instructions and professional renewal/disconnection appointments. Disconnection is not removal of an implanted port.

Medication review

Review interactions and supplements with pharmacy. Check fluorouracil interactions including warfarin, phenytoin and DPD inhibitors. Discuss fertility, pregnancy, contraception and breastfeeding for the complete regimen.

Contact and follow-up

Give the guide, passport and contact card. Use teach-back for fever/illness, chest or breathing symptoms, severe bowel symptoms and line problems. New eye symptoms or infected/blistering skin need prompt review.

Missing inputs remain unassessed; independent clinical/pharmacy review pending. RAS selection applies to colorectal cancer; 00207 head/neck radiotherapy is separate. Cetuximab premedication, skin recurrence and post-treatment electrolyte checks. FOLFOX4 table lists folinic acid on Day 1 only, while fluorouracil is Days 1 and 2. Confirm the Day 2 folinic-acid prescription; do not infer it from another protocol.

Sources: NCCP 00692 · EMA Erbitux information · NCCP antiemetic guidance